Photograph by SEEYA KESERKAR

Photographs by ISHITA SITWALA



Green Brutalist

In Ahmedabad, Malay Doshi, director, Studio Saransh, challenges the notion that concrete is unsuitable for the heat. At MS House, the architecture was literally shaped by nine mature neem trees, using their dense canopies as a biological shield. “What started as a commitment to retain the trees evolved into a climatic strategy,” he says. The architecture bends to nature; a boundary wall curves around a trunk, and openings are guided by the spread of the tree canopies. “Neem, known for its dense foliage is incredibly well-suited to Ahmedabad’s climate,” says Doshi. While the house is built in a raw Brutalist style, cavity walls along the exposed south and west facades serve as a thermal buffer. Deep-set, recessed openings cut down direct solar ingress while letting in filtered light. A gazebo on the roof houses a solar panel system that generates 70 to 80 per cent of the home’s energy. By treating energy infrastructure as part of the design thinking rather than an afterthought, the home achieves a seamless, year-round efficiency.

